

PROJECT DESIGN PHASE

Problem–Solution Fit Canvas | Import Data Using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)

Date	03 October 2026	Team ID	SWTID-2026-7959	Project	Import Data Using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)
------	-----------------	---------	-----------------	---------	--

1. CUSTOMER SEGMENT(S)

- Primary: ServiceNow administrators managing employee data.
- HR/admin staff maintaining employee lists.
- Teams importing spreadsheet-based employee records.
- Report viewers who need employee lists and summaries.
- Assumption: small teams with limited automation resources.

2. JOBS-TO-BE-DONE / PROBLEMS

- Import employee data without retyping every row.
- Map Employee ID, Name, Email, Department, Location.
- Transfer staged rows into the target employee table.
- Reduce accidental duplicate record creation.
- Check whether imported data is accurate and complete.
- Review employees by list, department, and location.

3. TRIGGERS

- New employees need to be added.
- An employee spreadsheet is updated.
- Existing records need refreshing.
- A team needs a current employee list.
- Department/location summaries are requested.

4. EMOTIONS: BEFORE / AFTER

Before (hypothesis): uncertainty about errors, duplicates, and manual effort.

After (intended): greater confidence, consistency, and visibility.

Validate these assumptions with actual users.

6. CUSTOMER CONSTRAINTS

- Spreadsheet columns must match expected source fields.
- Incorrect or missing values can cause data-quality issues.
- Manual entry is time-consuming for repeated imports.
- Users need appropriate ServiceNow access and permissions.
- Coalesce settings can affect duplicate/update behaviour.
- Large-volume performance limits are not yet documented.

9. PROBLEM ROOT CAUSE

- Employee details are supplied in a spreadsheet format.
- Source columns and target fields require explicit mapping.
- Manual transfer can introduce typing and copy errors.
- Repeated imports need a consistent process.
- Duplicate handling depends on matching/coalesce configuration.
- Customer interviews are not documented; causes are inferred.

10. YOUR SOLUTION

- Stage spreadsheet rows in Employee Import (u_employee_import).
- Use a Transform Map with five field mappings.
- Transfer data to Employee Test (u_employee_test).
- Use coalesce matching; current screenshot shows Employee Name enabled.
- Review the six sample records SB0001–SB0006.
- Use Employees List, Employees by Department, and Employees by Location.
- Verify coalesce choice before production use; Employee ID may be more unique.

5. AVAILABLE SOLUTIONS

- Manual entry into employee records.
- Spreadsheet-based storage and filtering.
- Import Set with a Transform Map in ServiceNow.
- Manual copy/paste between spreadsheet and system.
- List reports for reviewing imported data.
- Trade-off: manual methods are simple but less repeatable.

7. BEHAVIOUR

- Prepare a spreadsheet with five employee columns.
- Upload/import the file into Employee Import (u_employee_import).
- Run the Sample Spreadsheet Import Transform Map.
- Inspect Employee Test (u_employee_test) records.
- Review Employees List and grouped reports.
- Correct source data or mappings when discrepancies appear.

8. CHANNELS OF BEHAVIOUR

ONLINE

- ServiceNow forms, lists, import set, and transform map.
- Spreadsheet file prepared or edited digitally.
- ServiceNow reports used to inspect results.

OFFLINE

- Staff request or share updated employee information.
- Administrator confirms field meanings and corrects source data.
- These channels are inferred; direct research is not documented.

Project evidence: ServiceNow Employee Import → Transform Map → Employee Test, with three employee reports.

Customer behaviour and emotions are hypotheses pending validation.

Supporting Notes & References

Problem–Solution Fit | Import Data Using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)

Documented project evidence

- Source/staging table: Employee Import (u_employee_import).
- Target table: Employee Test (u_employee_test).
- Field mappings: Employee ID, Name, Email, Department, and Location.
- Sample records: SB0001–SB0006 (six employee records).
- Reports: Employees List, Employees by Department, Employees by Location.
- The supplied Transform Map screenshot shows coalesce enabled on Employee Name.

Assumptions to validate with users

- Confirm whether administrators, HR staff, or another role is the primary customer segment.
- Ask how often spreadsheet imports occur and how many rows are typical.
- Measure manual effort and the frequency of duplicate or incorrect records.
- Confirm the preferred unique matching field, such as Employee ID.
- Ask which reports are most useful and who consumes them.
- Check actual emotions, triggers, and offline coordination steps through interviews.

References

- Problem–Solution Fit Canvas 2.0, supplied sample PDF; canvas sections and prompts.
- Project screenshots supplied in the conversation: transform map, field mappings, import/target tables, sample records, and reports.
- <https://www.ideahackers.network/problem-solution-fit-canvas/>
- <https://medium.com/@epicantus/problem-solution-fit-canvas-aa3dd59cb4fe>